ہائیر ایجوکیشن کمیشن

HIGHER EDUCATION COMMISSION

Government of Pakistan, Islamabad

(Curriculum Division)

ENDORSEMENT OF THE COURSE DESIGN COMMITTEE

A meeting of a course design committee was held on 11 August 2023 in the Higher Education Commission, Lahore (Regional Office) to design a two credits course of **"Islamic Studies"** as part of the general education component of the HEC Undergraduate Education Policy (V 1.1).

Following members of the committee attended the meeting and developed the draft of the course:

1. Dr. Qibla Ayaz, Chairman, Council of Islamic Ideology, Islamabad
2. Dr. Fareed Ud Din Tariq, Professor, Department of Islamic Studies, University of Azad Jammu and Kashmir, Muzaffarabad
3. Dr. Muhammad Abdullah, Professor and Director, Shaikh Zayed Islamic Center, University of the Punjab, Lahore
4. Dr. Zahid Ali Zahidi, Professor and Dean, Faculty of Islamic Studies, University of Karachi, Karachi
5. Dr. Zia-ur-Rehman, Professor and Chairman, Department of Qurānic Studies, Islamia University of Bahawalpur, Bahawalpur
6. Dr. Hafiz Abdul Ghani, Associate Professor and Chairperson, Department of Religious Studies, Forman Christian College, Lahore
7. Dr. Hafiz Muhammad Sajjad, Associate Professor, Department of Interfaith Studies, Faculty of Arabic and Islamic Studies, Allama Iqbal Open University, Islamabad
8. Dr. Hassan Shakeel Shah, Associate Professor and Chairperson, Department of Islamic Thought and Civilization, University of Management and Technology, Lahore
9. Dr. Zainul Abddin Arijo, Associate Professor, Institute of Islamic Studies, Shah Abdul Latif University, Khairpur
10. Dr. Aurangzeb Haneef, Assistant Professor, Mushtaq Ahmad Gurmani School of Humanities and Social Sciences, Lahore University of Management Sciences, Lahore
11. Dr. Muhammad Feroz-ud-Din Shah, Assistant Professor, Department of Islamic Studies, University of Sargodha, Sargodha
12. Mr. Muhammad Ali Baig, Deputy Director, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad

Following members of the committee could not attend the meeting due to official / other commitments:

1. Dr. Muhammad Saleem Hawed, Professor and Dean, Faculty of Islamic and Oriental Studies, University of Peshawar, Peshawar
2. Dr. Sahibzada Baz Mohammad, Professor and Chairperson, Department of Islamic Studies, University of Balochistan, Quetta
3. Dr. Hafiz Taj Afsar, Associate Professor and Deputy Dean, Faculty of Usuluddin, International Islamic University, Islamabad
4. Dr. Muhammad Farooq Haider, Associate Professor and Chairperson, Department of Islamic Studies, Government College University, Lahore

That after consultation and endorsement of the committee, the final draft of the course is hereby submitted to the office of the Director Curriculum Division, HEC, Islamabad by us / the undersigned on behalf of the committee for consideration of HEC.

Dr. Qibla Ayaz
(Convener)

Dr. Zahid Ali Zahidi
(Co-Convener)

Mr. Muhammad Ali Baig
(Secretary)

PLEASE NOTE:

1. The Curriculum Division, HEC may conduct an internal review of the draft submitted by the committee and make necessary amendments as and when needed, with or without sharing reasons of the same with the committee.
2. The Curriculum Division, HEC may refer the draft submitted by the committee to other experts or a new committee for review who may propose revisions / additional recommendations in the said draft.

ISLAMIC STUDIES

UGE Policy V 1.1 : General Education Course

Credits: 02
Pre-Requisite: Nil
Offering: Undergraduate Degrees (including Associate Degrees)
Placement: 1 - 4 Semesters
Type: General Education
Fields: All

DESCRIPTION

This course is designed to provide students with a comprehensive overview of the fundamental aspects of Islam, its beliefs, practices, history and influence on society. It will further familiarize the students with a solid foundation in understanding Islam from an academic and cultural perspective. Through this course, students will have an enhanced understanding of Islam's multifaceted dimensions which will enable them to navigate complex discussions about Islam's historical and contemporary role, fostering empathy, respect, and informed dialogue.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Demonstrate enhanced knowledge of Islamic foundational beliefs, practices, historical development, spiritual values and ethical principles.
2. Describe basic sources of Islamic law and their application in daily life.
3. Identify and discuss contemporary issues being faced by the Muslim world including social challenges, gender roles and interfaith interactions.

SYLLABUS

1. **Introduction to Islam:**
   - Definition of Islam and its core beliefs.
   - The Holy Quran (introduction, revelation and compilation).
   - Hadith and Sunnah (compilation, classification, and significance).
   - Key theological concepts and themes (Tawhid, Prophethood, Akhirah etc.).
2. **Sirah of the Holy Prophet (Peace Be Upon Him) as Uswa-i-Hasana:**
   - Life and legacy of the Holy Prophet PBUH.
   - Diverse roles of the Holy Prophet PBUH (as an individual, educator, peace maker, leader etc.).
3. **Islamic History and Civilization:**
   - World before Islam.
   - The Rashidun Caliphate and expansion of Islamic rule.
   - Contribution of Muslim scientists and philosophers in shaping world civilization.
4. **Islamic Jurisprudence (Fiqh):**
   - Fundamental sources of Islamic jurisprudence.
   - Pillars of Islam and their significance.
   - Major schools of Islamic jurisprudence.
   - Significance and principles of Ijtihad.
5. **Family and Society in Islam:**
   - Status and rights of women in Islamic teachings.
   - Marriage, family, and gender roles in Muslim society.
   - Family structure and values in Muslim society.
6. **Islam and the Modern World:**
   - Relevance of Islam in the modern world (globalization, challenges and prospects).

- Islamophobia, interfaith dialogue, and multiculturalism.
- Islamic viewpoint towards socio-cultural and technological changes.

SUGGESTED INSTRUCTIONAL / READING MATERIALS

1. "The Five Pillars of Islam: A Journey Through the Divine Acts of Worship" by Muhammad Mustafa Al-Azami.
2. "The Five Pillars of Islam: A Framework for Islamic Values and Character Building" by Musharraf Hussain.
3. "Towards Understanding Islam" by Abul A' la Mawdudi.
4. "Islami Nazria e Hayat" by Khurshid Ahmad.
5. "An Introduction to Islamic Theology" by John Renard.
6. "Islamic Civilization Foundations Belief & Principles" by Abul A' la Mawdudi.
7. "Women and Social Justice: An Islamic Paradigm" by Dr. Anis Ahmad.
8. "Islam: Its Meaning and Message" by Khurshid Ahmad.

Note: This course is compulsory for Muslim and optional for non-Muslim undergraduate students. Non-Muslim students can opt for any course of at least the same or more credits in subjects such as religious studies, ethics, theology, comparative religion, Christian ethics, etc.